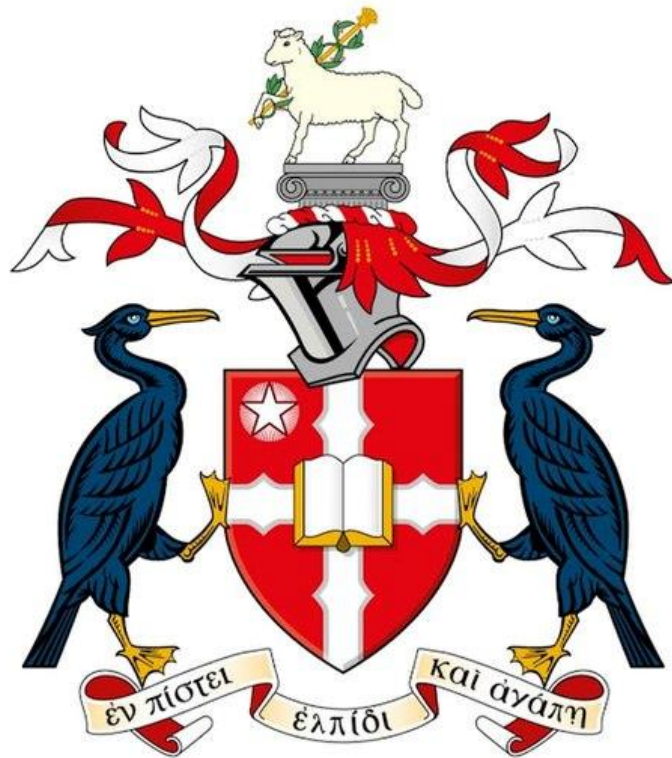




LIVERPOOL HOPE UNIVERSITY

Building the Foundations of Success

Short Course 2024

Name: _____



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ACADEMIC MOTIVATION

UNDERSTANDING YOUR MOTIVATIONS FOR LEARNING

WHAT IS ACADEMIC MOTIVATION?

Academic motivation is the drive, desire, and willingness that you have to engage in learning and educational activities. It can be characterised as the internal or external factors that stimulate and help to maintain your interest, effort, and persistence in your academic studies. Academic motivation plays a crucial role in your educational journey as it influences your level of engagement, goal-setting, and even your overall academic achievement.



ACTIVITY 1



Scan the QR code or visit <https://www.menti.com/alxv8wp8cstd> or go to [menti.com](https://www.menti.com) and use the access code **5993 6635** to add some words or phrases that describe what it is that is motivating you to study your chosen subject at University. Add as many words as you want.

ACTIVITY 2

IDENTIFY YOUR GOALS AND INTERESTS

Learning for personal development is an empowering process where individuals actively seek to acquire knowledge, skills, and attitudes that enhance their personal growth and overall well-being. This journey is unique for everyone, as it often aligns with individual goals, passions, and values. You may think in the short-term and the long-term to identify goals and interests.

1. **Reflect on Your Passions:** What excites you? What topics or activities make you feel alive and motivated?

2. **Set Clear Objectives:** What do you want to achieve? Whether it's improving your communication skills, learning a new language, or developing emotional intelligence, having clear goals will give your learning direction

ACTIVITY 3

THE ACADEMIC MOTIVATION SCALE



Scan the QR code to complete the Academic Motivation Scale or go to https://liverpoolhope.fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_8Dq6jjWDqU2qbZA when you have completed the questionnaire check your email inbox for your personal scores on the Academic Motivation Scale

ABOUT THE SCALE

You have just completed a questionnaire called the **Academic Motivation Scale** (also known as the AMS). The purpose of this questionnaire was to gather some information about your thoughts about your study habits, learning skills, and your attitudes and approaches to study. This handout describes how to interpret your scores, so you can figure out what the scores mean. The AMS measures seven aspects of academic motivation and you were asked to respond on a scale of 1 - 7 with the headings of 'does not correspond at all' (1) to 'corresponds exactly' (7). The minimum score you could get on the total scale is 4 and the maximum score is 28. In all aspects **except for** Amotivation, a higher score is better.

Table 1. The seven aspects of Academic Motivation

INTRINSIC MOTIVATION	• to know - the motivation you have for learning simply to know, enjoy and be satisfied by understanding new things • for accomplishment - for the purpose of accomplishment, enjoying the sense of achievement, satisfaction from earning good grades • for the experience - to feel stimulated, happy, excited by the new experiences
EXTRINSIC MOTIVATION	• identified - you recognise the importance of the learning to achieve goals • introjected - to prove to yourself that you can do something, for the feeling of importance • external - for external reward, such as higher earning power, career motivation
AMOTIVATION	• lack of motivation – the experience of having little or no motivation to learn or study

INTERPRETING YOUR SCORES

Average scores for males and females from a sample of 745 people are shown in the table below.

Table 2. Average scores of Males and Females on the Academic Motivation Scale from Vallerand, et al. (1992)

	Males (n = 261)	Your score	Females (n = 484)
Intrinsic Motivation			
to know	18.89		20.46
for accomplishment	15.93		17.52
for experience	12.21		13.83
Extrinsic Motivation			
identified	21.60		22.19
introjected	16.00		17.80
external regulation	21.78		21.80
Amotivation			
lack of motivation	6.74		7.51

We would expect that your scores would be comparable with the mean (average) scores shown in Table 2.

Remember the lowest score on each aspect is 4, and the highest is 28. If you have a low score on Intrinsic or Extrinsic Motivation, there are some suggestions in the following section for you to consider.

If you have a high score on Amotivation you may want think about your reasons for wanting to go to university and follow some of the suggestions below, as motivation is something that can be improved when nurtured.

This information is intended to help you understand your own motivation and determine the best approach towards your academic studies, but also identify possible areas for improvement. You may want to use this feedback to be proactive about improving your motivation or approach to learning. All the attitude and approaches to study skills mentioned on your feedback sheet are learnable. This is an important idea to remember, especially when at university.

We have provided some hints to go along with each primary dimension. We hope you find these suggestions helpful. But keep in mind that these are not the only ways to improve each area. Allowing yourself this time and space to reflect on your motivations will help you to focus on where you feel you will benefit most. There are no right or wrongs in terms of intrinsic and extrinsic motivation, however it is preferable to aim to strike a balance between the two.

INTRINSIC MOTIVATION

There are benefits and drawbacks to each aspect of motivation. Some of the **benefits** of being intrinsically motivated are:

- 
- Intrinsic Motivation is not dependent on external rewards
 - Intrinsic Motivation relates positively to learning and achievement
 - Individuals who score higher in Intrinsic Motivation are more likely to actively participate in class discussion
 - Those high in Intrinsic Motivation tend to have the ability to organise new knowledge and relate it to existing knowledge
 - They also tend to have an ability to apply skills and knowledge to reality

There are also some **possible drawbacks** to being highly intrinsically motivated:

- You can sometimes lose track of time and space when working on a task
- You may tend to focus on the tasks you enjoy most...
- ...leaving you not enough time to learn or perform other required tasks

THINGS TO THINK ABOUT

If your intrinsic motivation scores are average or above average, then you have little to be concerned about. You will typically exhibit the kind of traits that we see in highly engaged students. However, to avoid the pitfalls of extremely high intrinsic motivation you may want to consider how you approach the myriads of tasks that you want to do. Planning and short-term goal setting for learning is a good way to manage your time effectively. This will allow you to switch focus to other important tasks, self-care, and having fun.

EXTRINSIC MOTIVATION

Some of the **benefits** of being extrinsically motivated are:

- You may be keen to learn to earn high grades or for your career goals
- You may be competitive with peers in your learning experience
- You are likely to compete for tangible rewards (e.g. honours and awards)
- You will have high performance goals and possible high expectations of yourself

There are also some **possible disadvantages** to being highly extrinsically motivated:

- Your goals tend to be long-term goals, and you are focussed on the 'prize' rather than the experience
- If there is no reward you may be less likely to participate in a task
- May be less likely to engage in cooperative behaviour (group work)

THINGS TO THINK ABOUT

If your extrinsic motivation scores are around the average, then you are in a good position to start. Most of us have a degree of extrinsic motivations in our careers! It is not ideal however if you are low in intrinsic motivation, but extremely high in extrinsic motivation. If all your



motivations for learning are dominated by external factors and rewards, you may experience stress when you achieve less than you would like.

To steer clear of the drawbacks of extremely high extrinsic motivation you may want to think about the following. Try to reframe your goals to personalise them, as opposed to externalising. Listen to praise when it is given. Work with your peers to support one another. During your studies you will have opportunities for formative feedback and the reward for participating in exercises with formative feedback is the extra support or advice that will help you to excel on your assessments.

This advice also applies to reading and preparing for classes, you will get a sense of satisfaction when you understand the subject in a more deep and meaningful way. You will be ready to ask questions, and you will feel more confident in your studies.

AMOTIVATION

We think that it is important to address amotivation, however many of the tips and suggestions will apply to all students, so please do read on, and see if any of these resonate with you to identify areas where you can develop.

As you can see in Table 2. typical students will have a low score on this dimension. A high score of anything above 12 suggests that you are having issues with your motivation for academic learning. Often amotivation is also something you will be experiencing outside of your academic studies, so you may also feel amotivated in other areas of your life.

THINGS TO THINK ABOUT

Firstly, it is important to identify any external factors that might be affecting your motivation. You may be having doubts about the course, or yourself, you may be unwell or have pressures that are preventing you focussing on your academic goals. If you can pinpoint a factor, then that can direct you to sources of help.

COURSE AND CAREER SUGGESTIONS

For career related wobbles it would be a good idea to seek support from a career advisor, or a trusted previous tutor. Being better informed about your choices will increase your sense of autonomy, and this in turn can impact motivation in a positive way. As a Liverpool Hope student, you will have access to My Career Centre which is full of resources to help you plan and achieve your career goals.

STUDY SKILLS SUGGESTIONS

You may be experiencing a wobble in your confidence, which is completely normal and something we will discuss further. The shift from school or previous education to university is a big transition. There are things that you can do to support the development of your motivation here too.

You can buy introductory course textbooks second hand or visit your local library to access textbooks. Your tutor can recommend some texts that relate to your chosen subject. Skim the



table of contents of the textbook and make a list of the three topics that most interest you most and of the three topics that least interest you. Pay particular attention to these topics.

- What is it about the three most interesting topics that makes you like them so much?
- What is it about the other three topics that make them unappealing to you?
- Can you find any of the characteristics of the three most interesting topics in the three least interesting topics?

If you identify what it is about the three most interesting topics that make you like them so much, you may be able to apply what you found to the three least interesting ones, and perhaps you'll find that those uninteresting topics aren't so uninteresting after all!

A bonus that comes from developing better study skills is that it usually results in lower levels of anxiety and an increased sense of autonomy and feeling of being prepared.

- Prepare well for the class and plan your schedule effectively. You will get weekly readings for most subjects, complete them and make notes of things you do not understand or questions you might have
- Try not to wait until the last minute to get things done. Leaving things late will not help your confidence, will not help you to ask questions and will make you feel challenged to participate actively in class
- Remind yourself that you've prepared well and if you are having difficulty with a topic or concept, you can bet that at least one other person in the room will be feeling the same way as you do
- Try to connect with groups set up for Freshers, there are usually Facebook or WhatsApp groups set up by students, for students. This may help build a sense of excitement for the experience
- Use a journal to note down at least one positive thing each day, no matter how big or small
- Ask for help when you need it, from peers, lecturers, university support systems, your family, or friends, or even your GP!

Remember that amotivation is a temporary state and it can be overcome!

REFERENCE

Vallerand, R. J., Pelletier, L. G., Blais, M. R., Briere, N. M., Senecal, C., & Vallieres, E. F. (1992). The Academic Motivation Scale: A measure of intrinsic, extrinsic, and amotivation in education. *Educational and psychological measurement*, 52(4), 1003-1017

NOTES:

[illegible]

WHAT IS ACADEMIC BEHAVIOURAL CONFIDENCE?

And now for the good news.... academic behavioural confidence is an attribute that can be learned and developed over time!

Scan the QR code or visit <https://www.menti.com/alewpcep3sbz> to briefly note factors that have influenced your academic confidence so far. These can be positive and negative factors, and we will take some time to discuss these in context of improving your academic behavioural confidence going forward

In breakout rooms you should discuss commonalities and differences in the factors that have influenced your confidence in your academic studies. Nominate a group member to feed back to the whole group.

[illegible]

ACTIVITY 2

THE ACADEMIC BEHAVIOURAL CONFIDENCE SCALE



Scan the QR code to complete the Academic Behavioural Confidence Scale or go to

https://liverpoolhope.fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_6u6CPvsXZ5Mou6q

When you have completed the questionnaire check your email inbox for your personal scores on the questionnaire.

ABOUT THE SCALE

You have just completed the Academic Behavioural Confidence Scale. This scale gives you a sense of how confident you feel about succeeding at university. As you can see from the results provided in your email, there are four elements that the authors report as making up ABC.

Table 1. The four aspects of Academic Behavioural Confidence Scale

GRADES	the confidence you have that you will be able to produce appropriate work and obtain appropriate grades at University level
VERBALISING	your confidence in your ability to ask questions and discuss ideas with other students, lecturers, in both lectures and smaller group settings
STUDYING	your confidence in your current skills that will aid learning, such as time management, organisation, library skills, and motivation
ATTENDANCE	your confidence that you be able to attend classes, lectures, practical sessions; and be punctual

INTERPRETING YOUR SCORES

In a previous study by Sander and Sanders (2009) they asked students from different academic disciplines to complete the ABC scale. The minimum score is 1, and the maximum score is 5. If you score 1 or 2 on any of the components of the ABC, this indicates a lack of confidence in your ability for that part of ABC. Whereas a score above 3.5 suggests that you are confident in your ability on that dimension. We anticipate that most students will have a score that is close to the averages shown in the table below.

Table 2. Average scores of students in three disciplines on the Academic Behavioural Confidence Scale from Sander & Sanders (2009)

	Psychology (n = 507)	Nutrition (n = 37)	Health & Social Care (n = 34)	Your Scores
Confidence in Grades	3.66	3.82	3.56	
Confidence in Verbalising	3.17	3.05	3.17	
Confidence in Studying	3.76	3.77	3.52	
Confidence in Attending	4.47	4.29	4.47	

If you have a low score on any of the four elements, there are some suggestions in the following section for you to consider.

If you score the same as, or higher than the average scores in Table 2, you can always benefit nurturing your confidence. This information is intended to help you determine your own confidence and subsequent approach to academic studies, but also identify possible areas for improvement. All the attitude and approaches to study skills mentioned on your feedback sheet are learnable. This is an important idea to remember, especially when at university.

We have provided some hints to go along with each dimension. We hope you find these suggestions helpful. But keep in mind that these are not the only ways to improve each area. Allowing yourself this time and space to reflect on your academic confidence will help you to focus on where you feel you will benefit most.

DEVELOPING ACADEMIC BEHAVIOURAL CONFIDENCE

THINGS TO THINK ABOUT

Firstly, you have been offered this opportunity to take part in this special programme. It has been created for you participate with a view to joining us in Foundation Year at Hope University. This suggests that the University believes that you have the aptitudes and potential to be able to study at a higher level than you have previously, despite any setbacks you have experienced so far.

Second, there is a whole support network built into the university systems, courses and services and these are available to all. It is up to you to take advantage of these opportunities when you study with us.

Third, there is nothing to prevent you from developing your academic confidence. It is not a fixed skill or aptitude, but rather a state of mind and attitude.

You may already score highly on some of the confidence measures, or you could feel a little overwhelmed right now but like any aptitude, you can always improve how you feel about your confidence in your academic studies. Below are some ideas about how you can work to develop and refine your confidence. While the activities might not directly relate to academic



studies, they are constructed to allow you to reflect on your own experiences, observations of others, the impact of positive emotions, and how to deal with feedback.

ACTIVITY 3

DEVELOPING CONFIDENCE FROM YOUR OWN EXPERIENCES

Think of something you do well. It could be beyond what you have done at school or in further education e.g. your life at home or at work. You might see this as a very small skill. Something as simple as...

- Are you good at keeping in touch with friends?
- Are you organised?
- Do you know how to dress in a stylish way?
- Are you good at sports?

I am good at:

- Did this skill happen instantly?
- Did you have to work at it and build your self-belief that you could do it well?
- How do you think that you can apply this to your life at University?

DEVELOPING CONFIDENCE FROM OBSERVATIONS

Observing a friend or family member succeed at a task can help to strengthen beliefs in your own abilities. Think about or write down an experience when you've seen someone else learn to do something well. It need not be related to your studies.



- Is there someone in your family or friendship group who has become very skilful at something?
- Can they play a musical instrument?
- Are they a good cook?
- Have you seen one of your friends play well at sport?

My friend/family member is good at:

What can you learn from watching someone else do something well?

- Did they succeed every time?
- What did they learn from bad experiences?
- Did it change their desire to continue the skill?

DEVELOPING CONFIDENCE FROM VERBAL FEEDBACK

Think back to a time when you've received encouragement, again this does not need to relate to academic studies, it can be something personal or generally encouraging. Picture the person in your mind

- What did they say to boost your confidence?
- What is it that makes you trust the opinion of that person? (qualifications? experience?)



- Did your confidence change because someone encouraged you?
- What could you learn from them that you can tell yourself when things are not going as well as expected?
- Why do you think their feedback is important to you?
- How do you think that you can apply this to your studies?

DEVELOPING CONFIDENCE FROM AN EMOTIONAL STATE

Having a positive mood and disposition can boost your self-belief, while anxiety and stress can undermine it. Think back to a time when you handled a stressful situation well or you were enjoying yourself.

- Perhaps you did well in a test or an exam?
- Did you help someone who was going through a difficult time?
- What kind of event made you feel happy and at ease?

- Did your confidence change, even temporarily, when you felt satisfied that you did something well?
- What qualities do you recognise in yourself when helping or supporting someone else?
- How do you think you can learn how to be more positive about your own confidence?



REMEMBER:

Nobody knows everything and learning is a lifelong journey.

Along the way, you will succeed at many things, and you may occasionally fail or fall short in some areas, your reflections on success and failure will help to determine your path in the journey you are about to take.

REFERENCE:

Sander, P., & Sanders, L. (2009). Measuring academic behavioural confidence: the ABC scale revisited. *Studies in Higher Education*, 34(1), 19-35.

NOTES:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

ACADEMIC SELF-REGULATION

UNDERSTANDING HOW YOU REGULATE YOURSELF FOR LEARNING

WHAT IS ACADEMIC SELF-REGULATION?

Academic self-regulation (ASR) is defined as your own thoughts, feelings, and actions that are focused on attaining goals you have set for yourself. Students who are self-regulated learners tend to be proactive in their efforts to learn, primarily because they are aware of their strengths and limitations and because they are guided by personally set goals and task-related strategies.

ACTIVITY 1



Scan the QR code or visit <https://www.menti.com/alkfnmkeryjd> or go to [menti.com](https://www.menti.com) and use the access code **1828 5153** to add some words or phrases that describe the emotions that you feel when you think about studying at University. Feel free to add as many as you want.

ACTIVITY 2

ACTIVITIES FOR SELF-REGULATION

Academic regulation can take many forms. It is as much about managing emotions and subsequent behaviour as it is about prioritising tasks and attending classes. We have two activities to illustrate how you need to learn how to manage yourself effectively when at University.

REGULATING YOUR ENVIRONMENT & EMOTIONS

1. Mindful Breathing Exercise

- **Purpose:** Help students regulate emotions and reduce stress.
- **How:** I am going to guide you through a short mindful breathing exercise. **You may turn off your video for this exercise if you are not comfortable with it on.** When I prompt you, I want you to close your eyes, focus on your breathing, and notice any thoughts or feelings without judgment. Just let them flow in and out of your mind. Try not to focus on the thoughts, just focus on your breathing.
- **Afterward:** How do you feel now, and how has the exercise impacted your thoughts and concentration.
- **Skills developed:** Emotion regulation, mindfulness, and focus.

Please put your camera back on now.

REGULATING ORGANISATION AND LEARNING RESPONSIBILITY

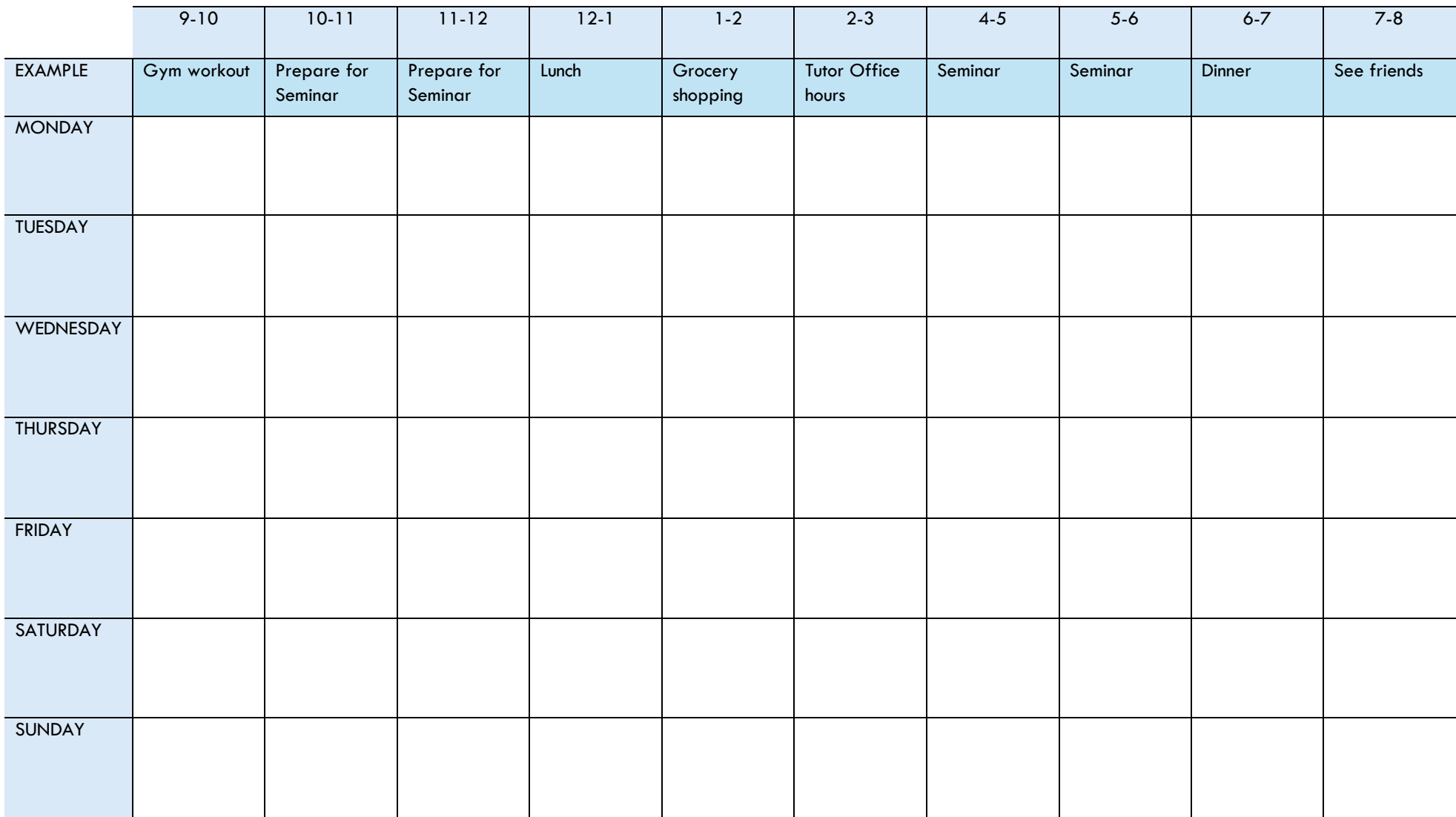
2. Time-Management Challenge

- **Purpose:** Improve students' ability to manage time and set priorities.
- **How:** On the PowerPoint is a list of tasks.
 - In a breakout room I want you to rank them by priority and estimate how long each task would take to complete.
 - Then, in your breakout room I want you discuss the level of priority for each task, decide on an appropriate amount of time necessary for each task.
 - Then plan your time for the week based on these tasks.

ORDER OF PRIORITY	TASK
1-Most important	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	
7	
8	
9	
10 – Least important	

TASK	TIME ESTIMATION
Study for a 1hr in-class test on Friday	
Plan an essay due in three weeks' time	
Attend classes & lectures (9hrs)	
Exercise or go to the gym	
Respond to emails and messages	
Spend time with family or friends	
Grocery shopping and food preparation	
Household chores/laundry/cleaning	
Read a book or articles to prepare for class	
Engage in your hobby or fun activity	

Now let's plan a sample weekly schedule based on this ranking. You have 7 days and need to balance high-priority tasks with regular responsibilities. Imagine you have 9 hours' worth of lectures and seminars per week.



- **Skills developed:** Time management, planning, task prioritisation.

ACTIVITY 3

THE ACADEMIC SELF-REGULATION SCALE



Scan the QR code to complete the Academic Self-Regulation Scale or go to https://liverpoolhope.fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_57Jmf2RzHwyCJiC

When you have completed the questionnaire check your email inbox for your personal scores on the Academic Self-Regulation Scale

ABOUT THE SCALE

You have just completed a questionnaire called the **Academic Self-Regulation Scale** (also known as the ASR). The purpose of this questionnaire was to gather some information about your thoughts about your study habits, learning skills, and your attitudes and approaches to study. This scale gives you a sense of awareness about your individual self-regulation and accountability for your own learning. As you can see from the results provided in your email, there are seven elements that the author believes make up Academic Self-Regulation.

Table 1. The seven aspects of Academic Self-Regulation

MEMORY STRATEGY	• the strategies that you use to help you to remember and learn
GOAL SETTING	• the short-term learning goals you put in place
SELF-EVALUATION	• your ability to accept feedback from different sources, and to acknowledge the areas where you can improve
SEEKING HELP	• asking academics, peers, and support staff for help when you feel that you need it
ENVIRONMENTAL REGULATION	• the strategies that you use in your learning environment to help you to focus your attention on the tasks that you need to complete
LEARNING RESPONSIBILITY	• your priorities in terms of your own learning, your ability to check work against criteria set and ensure that it is of an acceptable standard before submission
ORGANISING	• how you choose to work, are you methodical or chaotic?

INTERPRETING YOUR SCORES

Magno (2010) asked 309 participants to complete the ASR scale. The minimum score is 1, and the maximum score is 4.

If you score 1 to 1.5 on any of the components of the ASR, this will indicate that your own thoughts, feelings, and actions are lower than average on that part of the scale. If you score highly on any of the ASR subscales, then this indicates you believe that you have positive strategies in place to support your own learning in those aspects of self-regulation. We anticipate that most students will score close to the averages shown in the table below.

Table 2. Mean scores of 309 participants on the Academic Self-Regulation Scale from Magno (2010)

ASR Subscale	Mean Score	Your Score
Memory Strategy	2.53	
Goal Setting	2.74	
Self-Evaluation	2.84	
Seeking Help	3.12	
Environmental Regulation	2.82	
Learning Responsibility	2.96	
Organising	3.26	

DEVELOPING ACADEMIC SELF-REGULATION

In a society with a million and one distractions competing for your attention and focus, it can be a challenge to regulate your own behaviour to focus on your learning goals. To get the best outcomes, you will likely need to work on your own self-regulation in relation to your learning.

Self-regulation is not a cognitive ability, or an academic performance skill. It is the self-directed process by which you transform your cognitive abilities into academic skills. Self-regulation is also a valuable process in employability. Employers favour individuals who are high in self-regulation, and those individuals tend to progress well in their desired field.

Based upon this you will be able to see how it is worth investing time in your own academic self-regulation. Below are some ideas about how you can work to develop and refine your self-regulation skills.

THINKING ABOUT THINKING

Before you put pen to paper or fingers to keyboard consider the task that you must complete, set achievable bite-sized goals, and plan strategically how you will achieve these goals. Pace yourself and be proactive with your time management.



Organise and transform any guidance provided. Understand how the task will be marked or graded.

THINGS TO CONSIDER

- Are you clear about what is expected of you?
- Have you read the guidance and marking criteria?
- Discuss different approaches to the task with your peers as you can all benefit from the insight of other people
- Vocalise your thoughts with others, talking through ideas can help you to organise your thoughts
- How interested are you in the topic? How can you increase your interest to help to motivate you?
- What knowledge/skills do you want to learn or consolidate from this task beyond obtaining a grade?
- What are your expectations of the outcome? Are they realistic?

How do you think that you can apply this to your studies?

THINKING ABOUT DOING...

When engaging with the task can you visualise what you want to achieve? Now you must apply self-control and attentional focus to the task. Keep notes about literature that is useful to your task, and it is good practice to keep a brief note for any papers that are not useful to save yourself time revisiting things that are not of use. You can outline a research study or summarise in a bit more detail. You will need to rearrange materials to suit the requirements of the task. Use tools such as highlighting, flashcards/index cards, draw pictures, diagrams, charts or use webs/mind mapping.

Use drafts and sensible file names rather than editing a single document. This ensures you will always have a back-up and will know which draft you should be working from. Find information from appropriate sources, journals, textbooks etc. Learn how to search the library and the internet effectively. There will be lots of guidance on this during your first year of studies, take advantage of opportunities to support effective research skills. Seek assistance from social sources, peers, lecturers, the library, learning mentors etc.



THINGS TO CONSIDER

- What kind of memory strategies will be most useful to you in your learning? Some people like visual strategies such as mind maps, some like to use text-based bullet journals, and others find that colour coding often helps organise thoughts. There are so many strategies you can use to support your learning, find something that works for you
- Find your method and refine it over time. Remember that it's ok to switch methods according to the task
- What is your study environment like? Is it adequate for your own needs?
- Make observations about yourself while engaged with a task. What kind of things distracted you? How can you make the environment work better for you?
- Remember to take regular breaks and give yourself treats to incentivise yourself

How do you think that you can apply this to your studies?

THINKING ABOUT HOW IT WENT

Once the task is complete you should always take some time to reflect. This is not the time to be judging your performance on a task, but to identify any aspects of good practice and any areas that were problematic, and why. Remember this is not about being overly critical, but about recognising where improvements can be made. List any errors made so that you do not repeat them, carefully read feedback on assessments, and ask for advice or clarity if needed. Recognising when you need support and asking for it is vital to your studies.

THINGS TO CONSIDER

- Do not attribute failures to 'fixed ability', use them as a learning experience, ask questions if you don't understand and take that information with you in a positive way
- Reflect upon and make notes about any skills or knowledge gained because of the task, and any subsequent feedback

How do you think that you can apply this to your studies?



REFERENCE

Magno, C. (2010). Assessing academic self-regulated learning among Filipino college students: The factor structure and item fit. *The International Journal of Education and Psychological Assessment*, 5, 61

NOTES:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

CRITICAL SKILLS

ASSESSING YOUR CRITICAL SKILLS

WHAT ARE CRITICAL SKILLS?

Critical skills are the skills that you will need to support you through university life and later employment. Attributes such as the ability to communicate effectively, collaborate with others, employ critical thinking and the ability to use technology.

ACTIVITY 1



Scan the QR code or visit <https://www.menti.com/alec5ehy9tta> to rank your confidence in the critical skills we have identified

ACTIVITY 2

MEASURING YOUR CRITICAL SKILLS



Across the university sector and in the world of work there is an increased emphasis on the development of critical skills and competencies. Next you should scan the QR code or click through to https://liverpoolhope.fra1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_0O3vhNsFk0CFMJJE

ABOUT THE SCALE

In Bray, Byrne, and O'Kelly's research (2020) they asked 1013 young adults to complete the scale. The minimum score is 1, and the maximum score is 5. If you score 1 or 2 on any of the components of the scale, this will indicate a lack of confidence in your ability for the related key skills. We anticipate that most students will score reasonably close to the averages shown in the table below. Some significant differences between male and female participants were observed, and they are also presented in the table below. Write your scores in the space provided to allow comparison.



There are also many free MOOCs (Massive Open Online Courses such as Coursera or Udemy) to help you to brush up on skills. If you live in Merseyside there are many free courses to develop confidence and assertiveness, to manage anxiety, men's mental health and these are held at [The Life Rooms](#), and many of the Life Rooms courses can be taken online too, all completely free. It is important to remember that these critical skills can all be learned and developed. It is well worth investing a little of your time to give yourself the best opportunities for your studies, and your future.

ACTION PLANNING FOR CRITICAL SKILLS

We have noted in the previous sessions that action planning is a good way to support your motivation, academic confidence and self-regulation. So, let's take some time to make an action plan for the critical skills where you currently feel least confident. Choose the two skills where you feel that you could improve, based on your personal scores from the Student's Confidence in Key Skills Scale in Activity 2.

EXAMPLE:

Goals should be specific. For example, if you are not confident with technology, select **one** aspect where you could improve such as 'I want to learn the basics of using Microsoft Excel'.

Goals should be measurable and achievable. Learning the basics of Excel is measurable and achievable. There are lots of YouTube videos to help you learn the basics such as [short videos](#) or [longer, more in depth resources](#). A Google search will also reveal different learning tools to support you.

Goals should be relevant and time bound. Using Excel is a skill that many employers like graduates to have. It is also relevant to many degree courses. So, now specify a time frame. For now, you should focus on short-term achievable goals, building to more long-term objectives.

1. Identified Critical Skill 1: _____

Short-Term Goal: _____

How do you think that you could you achieve this goal? Note any ideas, and resources you might need.



Set a realistic deadline: _____

Track your progress, set up a system to monitor success: _____

Reflect on your confidence on completion of the goal: _____

2. Identified Critical Skill 2: _____

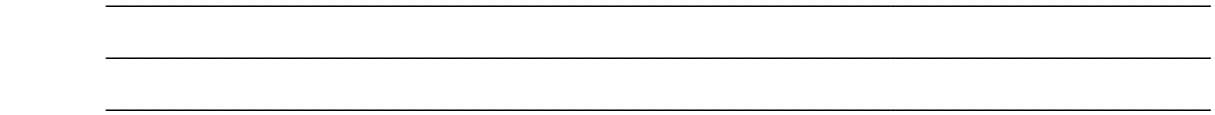
Short-Term Goal: _____

How do you think that you could you achieve this goal? Note any ideas, and resources you might need.

Set a realistic deadline: _____

Track your progress, set up a system to monitor success: _____

Reflect on your confidence on completion of the goal: _____



Bray, A., Byrne, P., & O'Kelly, M. (2020). A short instrument for measuring students' confidence with 'key skills'(sicks): Development, validation and initial results. *Thinking Skills and Creativity*, 37, 100700

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



REFLECTIVE ESSAY WRITING GUIDE

SUPPORT FOR REFLECTIVE ESSAY WRITING

WHAT IS A REFLECTIVE ESSAY?

As a part of this programme, you are expected to write four brief reflective essays about the following topics, after you have taken part in the associated sessions.

Writing a reflective essay involves analysing your personal experiences, thoughts, and emotions related to a particular event or topic.

WHAT DO I NEED TO DO?

You need to write four essays each of 500 words. The topics we will be covering are:

- Academic Motivation
- Academic Behavioural Confidence
- Academic Self-Regulation
- Critical Skills

Each essay should reflect upon these topics in turn following the accompanying session.

Here's a step-by-step guide to help you prepare:

1. UNDERSTAND THE PURPOSE

Reflective essays are meant to provide insight into your personal experiences and how they have shaped your thoughts and actions. The goal is to explore what you've learned and how you've changed.

2. BE CLEAR ABOUT THE TOPIC

The sessions that are being delivered have been designed to allow you to think carefully about what has influenced you, and how you have reflected on your own attitudes, aptitudes, and understanding from the topics we have covered. You should make sure to relate your reflections to each individual topic, including how you propose to use this knowledge to move forward with your studies.

3. BRAINSTORM AND REFLECT

Free Writing is a good first step in the process. Spend time writing down your thoughts and feelings about the experience. Don't worry about structure, just get your ideas out.

Ask yourself reflective questions:

- What did you think about your attributes/skills/attitude before the short course?
- How did the program make you feel?
- What did you learn about yourself from the experience?
- Has it had any impact on you?

- 
- How has it influenced your future actions or thoughts?

4. ORGANISE YOUR THOUGHTS

Create a Mind Map: This method can help you to visualise the connections between your thoughts, feelings, and the lessons learned from the course.

Outline the Essay: Structure your essay with an introduction, body paragraphs, and a conclusion. Remember to adhere to the word limit.

5. DEVELOP A REFLECTIVE STATEMENT

The statement should briefly summarise the main lesson or insight gained from your experience. It should be no more than a couple of sentences to introduce the reader to the essay.

Apply Reflective Insight: Ensure that your reflective statement conveys a sense of personal growth or change.

6. RESEARCH (IF NECESSARY)

Supporting Material: For these reflective essays research is not particularly necessary, however you will complete four questionnaires that indicate your personal scores on each topic. You should aim to relate these to your experience.

7. PLAN YOUR ESSAY STRUCTURE

Introduction:

- Briefly introduce the experience and present your reflective statement.

Body Paragraphs:

- Describe the Experience: Provide very brief details about the topic.
- Analyse the Experience: Discuss your feelings, thoughts, and reactions.
- Reflect on the Impact: Explain what you learned and how it has affected you.

Conclusion:

- Summarise the key points and restate the significance of the experience.

8. CONSIDER THE TONE AND STYLE

Your essay should be personal and reflective: Use the first-person narrative (e.g., "I learned," "I felt") to convey your personal thoughts.

It should also contain an element of analytical insight: Balance personal reflection with analytical insight, avoiding overly emotional language.



9. PREPARE TO REVISE THE DRAFT

We appreciate that you do not have a lot of time to complete these essays, but it is academic good practice to write a first draft without worrying too much about perfection. Focus on getting your ideas down. After the first draft we do expect that you review and revise. Read your draft critically, considering the clarity of your reflections and the coherence of your arguments.

10. FINAL EDITING

Proofread: Check for grammar, punctuation, and spelling errors.

Polish: Ensure that your essay flows well and that your reflections are clear and insightful.

By following these steps, you'll be well-prepared to write a thoughtful and effective reflective essay.



FEEDBACK GUIDE

TIPS ON HOW TO GET THE MOST OUT OF YOUR FEEDBACK

ABOUT THE GUIDE

This guide aims to highlight some tips to help you understand your feedback and pointers for how to move forward with feedback.

Why should feedback be important to you?

- It helps to improve your learning development
- It highlights your strengths and any areas you might need to develop
- It helps you understand why you achieved a particular mark or grade
- It helps with improving on your next assessment or exam

Remember feedback is about self-development, reflection and empowering you to be more successful in your academic studies.

ONE

HOW AND WHEN TO ENGAGE WITH YOUR FEEDBACK

Make sure to find the right time and location to read your feedback! If you're in a rush, try to read your feedback in more depth later, do not just focus on the grade. Think about your strengths and weaknesses before and after reading your feedback and try to make connections. Make a copy of your feedback so you can reflect on your individual progress throughout the year.

TWO

MAKE NOTES FROM YOUR PERSPECTIVE

Try to answer

- What are the key things you did well?
- What did you learn from your coursework and feedback?
- How can you relate your feedback to what you already know?
- Can you apply what you've learnt to future assessments?

Remember not to be over critical or compare yourself to others. Everyone is at a different stage of their personal development. It's important to recognise your own efforts! You are unique and we all learn in different ways.

THREE

DISCUSS YOUR FEEDBACK WITH THE MARKING TUTOR

To get the best advice from the marking tutor begin by asking yourself:

- 
- Do you understand the comments your marking tutor provided?
 - Is the feedback specific enough or too specific?

Challenge yourself as well as the marking tutor to get the most out of this process! Look at your tutor's office hours, drop them an email, or book an appointment to clarify any concerns if necessary. We want to work with you to make sure you understand your feedback well!

Before your meeting look back at any assessment guidance or any available marking rubric/criteria;

- Reflect honestly and ask yourself do you think you met the criteria?
- Have some questions prepared and take notes from the advice provided.

FOUR

DEVELOP AN ACTION PLAN

Creating a plan can help you to identify areas you need to develop. Focus on how you think you can work on those areas.

Action Plan Points:

- What should I do to increase my confidence and understanding of the topic?
- Will further research and reading help? (Almost certainly is the answer to that!)
- Should I ask others for help (especially peers, someone who's in the same position as me) around feedback and information?

FIVE

APPLYING FEEDBACK TO YOUR NEXT ASSESSMENT

Even if the type of assessment is quite different to the last, the principles of feedback can still apply. Here's some useful tips.

- Use your action plan
- Reread your feedback and make sure that you act upon it.
- Always keep a copy of your feedback and feedback reflections handy when working on your next assessment.
- Always have a copy of the assessment guidance and the rubric/marking criteria handy too.
- Make a brief outline of the aims and objectives of the assessment. You can always check this with the course leader or lecturer. Allow them to correct you if you are not understanding.
- Remember that office hours are your friend!

ORGANISE AND RECHARGE

Sometimes your schedule can be hectic, this can increase stress and anxiety and can make you feel muddled and lack confidence. Some thoughts about organising and recharging.

- Consider using the Pomodoro Technique for studying (might not work for everyone!):
 - Choose a task from your to-do list
 - Set a timer for 25 minutes
 - Work on the task until the timer rings
 - Mark the task off your to-do list or mark off the parts you have completed and modify if necessary
 - Take a short break of 3–5 minutes
 - Repeat until the task is finished
 - After four pomodoros, take a longer break of 15–30 minutes
- Remember your action plan, keep referring to it.
- Make small, achievable goals such as read a paper or a book chapter.
- Have a brain dump of assessment related thoughts and ideas onto paper (or Word!), these can always be edited.
- Take regular rest breaks, our campus is beautiful, it is full of wildlife and restful gardens. Take advantage of this and go for a walk around. Clearing the mind can help you figure out solutions when you are stuck.

If you are feeling overwhelmed, you should;

- Talk to your personal tutor, they can help you with an action plan and direct you to appropriate support.
- Take advantage of student mentors, extra sessions, library and student support services.

SOME FINAL THOUGHTS

- You are not your grade/mark!
- You need to rest and have fun as well as preparing for study and learning.
- You are person with an existence outside of University and you must find some balance.
- Your tutors are there to help. Use office hours or make an appointment.
- Support is available for you if you are struggling academically, physically or emotionally.
- Try to get involved in the academic community. Be a part of effecting change by becoming a Student Rep or joining a society. Developing an identity that aligns with your subject area, or your outside interests will help you make bonds with others and grow a network of supportive friends and peers.
- It is part of our job to help you to succeed, but the responsibility for learning is yours and yours alone.